

diary, "I feel guilty. I feel as if I ought not to saunter and loiter and trifle away this time. I feel as if I ought to be employed for the benefit of my fellow men."

We don't have to go back three hundred years to find people who believe struggle is good and taking life easy is bad. Take Lee Iacocca. He became president of Ford and then got fired. "Should I pack it all in and retire?" he asked himself. "I was 54 years old. I had already accomplished a great deal. I was financially secure. I could afford to play golf for the rest of my life. But that just didn't feel right."

Iacocca is neither colonial nor Protestant. But Iacocca seems driven by the work values Greven describes. After Ford he looked around for another hole to fill. He found it in Chrysler, probably the most punishing job in the country at the time. For Iacocca, taking on Chrysler "felt right."

The Chrysler story has a happy ending. Iacocca turned Chrysler around and wrote a book about himself. He's a hero, America's favorite businessman. In his autobiography he's a very appealing guy. But what hole can he fill now? He headed the 1986 Statue of Liberty committee and got fired again. In his world, you've got to continue to dig. But what happens at the end of a lifetime of digging?

Colonials looked to hard work for that sense of suffering they valued so highly. Their work ethic has survived in even better shape than masochism. J. Paul Getty, for example, was taught that "an individual had to work to justify his existence." Getty retired at age 24, during World War I, and spent the war years playing and enjoying himself. But he finally concluded he was "wasting time" and, although he was already a millionaire, at age 26 he went back to work.

We "new breed" types are supposed to have a new work ethic. It includes "duty to oneself" as well as the job, and even admits to a little pleasure. If you're a baby boomer, when you went to college people said you were part of a "Me" generation. I suppose that means we think masochism is bad and pleasure is good. But the cultural pull Greven